



Summary Post

by [Mariam Ibrahim Ismail Hasan Almarzooqi](#) - Thursday, 11 December 2025, 8:45 AM

The situation involving Abi presents a complex ethical dilemma centered on data integrity and the responsible reporting of research results. While fabricating data is universally unethical, selectively presenting only positive findings can be equally harmful. Bouaziz, Brulin, and Campo (2022) emphasize that even unintentional misinterpretation or selective disclosure of results can mislead stakeholders and produce an inaccurate understanding of a product's effectiveness. In Abi's case, pressure to highlight only favorable outcomes raises significant concerns regarding transparency, honesty, and scientific rigor.

Researchers have a professional and moral responsibility to communicate their findings truthfully, even when results do not align with sponsor expectations. Salonen (2024) stresses that ethical research practices depend on openness and integrity to maintain public trust. Omitting or downplaying negative findings erodes scientific credibility and may put consumers at risk, particularly when the research relates to health, nutrition, or other areas with direct public impact. Therefore, full and accurate reporting is essential not only for upholding research standards but also for ensuring that individuals can make informed, safe decisions based on reliable data.

Beyond ethical implications, Abi also faces potential reputational and legal consequences if she participates in selective reporting. According to Kitchen and Tourky (2022), misrepresentation in product communication can result in significant penalties, including lawsuits, fines, and long-term brand damage. If a company chooses to publicize only favorable results, Abi risks being viewed as complicit in misleading consumers and stakeholders. To protect her professional integrity, she should strongly advocate for complete disclosure of all research findings. If the organization continues to insist on selective reporting, withdrawing from the project may be the most ethical and responsible course of action.

References:

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